

ATTACHMENT B

REQUEST FOR APPROVAL OF PROCUREMENT CONTRACTS NOT UNDER DELEGATED AUTHORITYA. APPROVAL OF PROFESSIONAL SERVICE CONTRACTS/AMENDMENTS/AUTHORIZATION TO INCREASE CONTRACT CAPACITY EXCEEDING \$250,000**Item M****DIVISION OF INSTRUCTION****\$28,667,558**

<u>CONTRACTOR</u>	<u>IDENTIFI- CATION NO.</u>	<u>CONTRACT TERM</u>	<u>SOURCE OF FUNDS</u>	<u>AMOUNT</u>
The Regents of the University of California, Los Angeles Campus (UCLA)	4400012970	06/15/24 – 06/30/27	Gates Foundation Math Equity Grant (100%)	\$1,648,244

Approval of a single-source contract for research and development services. In 2021, the Gates Foundation K12 team developed the Research and Development (R&D) Partnership for Math Equity Grant program with the goal of increasing the availability of high-quality math instructional materials, particularly for Black and Latin/x students and students living in poverty. The grant was designed to support the investigation and improvement of math digital tools and platforms.

Per the grant, the Gates Foundation requires three partners for the R&D partnership: a Local Education Agency (LEA), a research institute, and a math digital tool. UCLA was named in the grant to be the research partner through their Los Angeles Education Research Institute (LAERI). UCLA LAERI will examine effective ways to support teachers' use of digital math tools in the classroom and will also study ways to increase students' engagement and motivation when using digital math tools throughout the year and in the summer months. The Grant award was ratified by the Board of Education on February 13, 2024 ([Board Report No. 080-23/24](#)).

Participating schools were selected based on usage of the current IXL digital tool platform and demographic information. This initiative aligns with Pillar 1, Academic Excellence; Pillar 2, Joy and Wellness; and Pillar 3, Engagement and Collaboration.

UCLA has a long history of partnering with the District. LAERI, in particular, is a long-standing partner research institute that has an excellent track record of successfully completing research projects for the District.

Requester:

Dr. Frances Baez, Chief Academic Officer
Division of Instruction

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Equity Impact:

Component	Score	Score Rationale
Recognition	3	This grant affirmatively recognizes historical inequities by focusing on fostering math learning, motivation, and engagement among Black, Latinx, and low-income students.
Resource Prioritization	4	This grant effectively prioritizes resources based on student need by specifically targeting schools that serve large populations of historically marginalized students.
Results	3	The grant is likely to result in closing achievement gaps because the funds will be used to implement and evaluate strategies for using digital tools to improve math knowledge, conceptual understanding, and engagement among Black, Latinx, and low-income students.
TOTAL	10	

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<u>CONTRACTOR</u>	<u>IDENTIFI- CATION NO.</u>	<u>CONTRACT TERM</u>	<u>SOURCE OF FUNDS</u>	<u>AMOUNT</u>
IXL Learning, Inc.	4400013070	06/15/24 – 06/30/27	Gates Foundation Math Equity Grant (100%)	\$1,337,134

Approval of a single-source contract for research and development services. In 2021, the Gates Foundation K12 team developed the Research and Development (R&D) Partnership for Math Equity Grant program with the goal of increasing the availability of high-quality math instructional materials, particularly for Black and Latin/x students and students living in poverty. The grant was designed to support the investigation and improvement of math digital tools and platforms.

Per the grant, the Gates Foundation requires three partners for the R&D partnership: a Local Education Agency (LEA), a research institute, and a math digital tool. After careful review of the District's existing list of digital tools, IXL was chosen to be a partner due to its capacity for personalization and its current adoption among middle and high school students. IXL is a research-based digital platform that has been shown to have a positive impact on student learning. Through collaboration with IXL, a comprehensive, personalized learning platform used widely throughout the District and nation, and a research team from UCLA LAERI, the District's long-standing research-practice partner, we will examine effective ways to support teachers' use of digital math tools in the classroom and will also study ways to increase students' engagement and motivation when using digital math tools throughout the year and in the summer months. The Grant award was ratified by the Board of Education on February 13, 2024 ([Board Report No. 080-23/24](#)).

Participating schools were selected based on usage of the current IXL digital tool platform and demographic information. This initiative aligns with Pillar 1, Academic Excellence; Pillar 2, Joy and Wellness; and Pillar 3, Engagement and Collaboration.

IXL has been a partner of the District since 2013.

Requester:

Dr. Frances Baez, Chief Academic Officer
Division of Instruction

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Equity Impact:

Component	Score	Score Rationale
Recognition	3	This grant affirmatively recognizes historical inequities by focusing on fostering math learning, motivation, and engagement among Black, Latinx, and low-income students.
Resource Prioritization	4	This grant effectively prioritizes resources based on student need by specifically targeting schools that serve large populations of historically marginalized students.
Results	3	The grant is likely to result in closing achievement gaps because the funds will be used to implement and evaluate strategies for using digital tools to improve math knowledge, conceptual understanding, and engagement among Black, Latinx, and low-income students.
TOTAL	10	

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<u>CONTRACTOR</u>	<u>IDENTIFI- CATION NO.</u>	<u>CONTRACT TERM</u>	<u>SOURCE OF FUNDS</u>	<u>AMOUNT</u>
McGraw Hill LLC;	4400013390	08/22/24 – 08/21/28	Various per	\$3,171,862
Houghton Mifflin	4400013379	includes two (2) one-	requesting	
Harcourt Publishing	(RFP 2000003261)	year renewal options	school or	
Company			office	
			(100%)	

Approval of two formally competed capacity contracts procured through a Request for Proposals (RFP) process, to establish tailored Tier 3 and Tier 2 literacy intervention programs for Grades 6-12 within Los Angeles Unified School District (“LAUSD”). Tier 3 literacy intervention programming is designed for students who are at least two grades below reading proficiency for their assigned grade level. Tier 2 literacy intervention programming is designed for students whose reading proficiency is one to two grade levels below their assigned grade level. This initiative, facilitated by comprehensive online platforms, aims to effectively address the diverse literacy needs of students through assessments, data reporting, and targeted intervention strategies. Teachers are to be supported in the design by receiving real time student data in areas that require additional development in addition to having access to administration training and onsite training to ensure that the programs are being implemented for maximum effectivity. The literacy intervention programs ensure students receive personalized learning plans, adaptive materials, and immediate feedback tools to support their progress in catching up and becoming proficient readers. This approach leverages technology and data-driven insights to provide timely and targeted support, fostering accelerated growth in reading proficiency among students in Grades 6-12 within LAUSD.

McGraw Hill LLC and Houghton Mifflin Harcourt Publishing Company (“HMH”), the sole implementers of programs Corrective Reading/ Achieve 3000 and Read 180 ED/Code, will provide comprehensive support and expertise in literacy intervention. Professional development and technical support for educators and administrators are integral components of the contract, ensuring proficiency in utilizing the platform and interpreting assessment data. By prioritizing research-based practices and adhering to District standards, the proposed program aims to establish a structured framework for improving literacy outcomes and fostering a culture of continuous learning and growth in reading instruction across all LAUSD.

Eleven proposals were received, and all deemed qualified. The source selection committee consisted of three subject matter experts from Division of Instruction and one from the Division of Special Education. Factors utilized to score the proposals included experience and qualifications of firm and personnel; technical solutions/project approach; Work Based Learning Participation (WBLP) plan; Small Business Enterprise (SBE) participation; and price. The two vendors with the highest scored rating were selected.

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McGraw Hill LLC has been doing business with LAUSD since 2014. Currently, McGraw Hill partners with LAUSD to implement Corrective Reading and Achieve Literacy in 23 priority middle school sites, focusing on improving literacy among the lowest-performing students. The initiative's early outcomes are highly positive, leading to the addition of 27 more interventionists trained to extend this successful approach. McGraw Hill LLC also collaborates with major urban districts like Miami-Dade, New York DOE, Milwaukee Public Schools, Prince Georges County Public Schools, and Anne Arundel Public Schools to provide advanced professional development and curriculum services.

HMH has been doing business with LAUSD since 2013. HMH Professional Services has served California districts for over 20 years, supporting literacy and Spanish literacy curriculum implementation. Instructional Coaches with expertise in literacy and multilingual learners provide targeted professional learning focused on actionable strategies for instructional excellence and student engagement.

This action aligns with the District's Strategic Plan, Pillar 1: High-Quality Instruction, particularly Priority 1A: High-Quality Instruction: Focus on consistent implementation of high-quality instruction to improve student outcomes; and Priority 1C: Eliminating Opportunity Gaps: Eliminate opportunity gaps, advance anti-racist instructional practices, and personalize learning for all students. Students who are reading at least three grades below grade level and whose literacy needs these intervention programs target, are unable to access grade-level material, which puts them further behind their peers if not remediated over time. Closing the achievement gap is essential for these students to continue successfully through their middle and high school education and ensure they are career ready when they graduate. The professional development from McGraw Hill LLC and Houghton Mifflin Harcourt Publishing Company will support teacher and students district wide by providing specialized support to struggling readers.

Requester:

Dr. Frances Baez, Chief Academic Officer
Division of Instruction

Equity Impact:

Component	Score	Score Rationale
Recognition	4	The literacy intervention programs procured by the District actively recognizes and specifies historical inequities to correct by prioritizing struggling readers who are not be receiving remediation support through other programs
Resource Prioritization	4	The literacy intervention programs procured by the District actively eeffectively prioritizes resources based on student need by identifying those with the greatest literacy gaps who are not being served by other programs
Results	4	The literacy intervention programs procured by the District are extremely likely to result in closed opportunity gaps and/or closing achievement gaps
TOTAL	12	

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<u>CONTRACTOR</u>	<u>IDENTIFI- CATION NO.</u>	<u>CONTRACT TERM</u>	<u>SOURCE OF FUNDS</u>	<u>AMOUNT</u>
Teaching Strategies, LLC	4400012930	08/14/24 – 08/13/29	General Funds (63%) Early Childhood Education Division Grant (37%)	\$8,000,000

Approval of a textbook purchase Master Agreement for adopted instructional materials with Teaching Strategies, LLC for the Creative Curriculum Program for use in grades Preschool/TK.

California law (Education Code section 48000) defines TK as “the first year of a two-year kindergarten program that uses a modified kindergarten curriculum that is age and developmentally appropriate.” While no state curriculum is mandated, pursuant to Education Code section 48000(f), TK programs are intended to be aligned to the California Preschool Learning Foundations developed by the California Department of Education.

Creative Curriculum was selected as it is aligned to the California Preschool Learning Foundations, developmentally appropriate, and is already being used by over 350 UTK classrooms and 86 Early Education Centers. The curriculum builds children’s confidence, creativity, and critical thinking skills through hands-on, project-based investigations and supports whole child development.

Unlike the state adoption process for Grades K-8, California Education Code section 60400 requires a Board-approved process for adoption that includes a legal compliance review.

UTK Teachers expressed strong positive feedback on the instructional materials reviewed using a rubric aligned with the California Department of Education Initial Selections Process. This rubric encompasses key areas such as alignment to the California Preschool Foundations Standards, Program Organization, Assessment, Universal Access, Instructional Planning and Support, and CDE Social Content Review (Education Code sections 60040-60045). The materials effectively address these critical components, providing a strong foundation for delivering a comprehensive and well-rounded early learning curriculum.

The LAUSD priorities of High-Quality Instruction, Enriching Experiences, and Eliminating Opportunity Gaps are directly addressed through curriculum aligned with the California Preschool Learning Foundations. This curriculum fosters high-quality instruction by providing clear developmental

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guidelines for educators. Furthermore, it promotes enriching experiences through its emphasis on hands-on learning activities integrated into everyday classroom interactions. By ensuring alignment with these foundations, the curriculum plays a critical role in reducing opportunity gaps and ensuring all students have access to a strong foundation for future academic success.

This contract supports the District’s Strategic Plan Pillar 1: Academic Excellence, Enriching Experiences, and Eliminating Opportunity Gaps; Pillar 2: Joy and Wellness, Strong Social Skills; and Pillar 3: Engagement and Collaboration, Strong Relationships.

Requesters:

Dr. Frances Baez, Chief Academic Officer
Division of Instruction

Dr. Dean Tagawa, Executive Director
Early Childhood Education Division

Equity Impact:

Component	Score	Score Rationale
Recognition	3	The publisher of Creative Curriculum has created materials that are intentional in their approach to address historical inequities. They achieve this through the following: Foundation Volumes: Each volume includes guidance to individualize learning experiences and interactions and to ensure they are reflective of the children’s community. Daily Resources: There is targeted guidance to support English-language learners and children with disabilities in the “Including All Children” sections throughout our daily plans and Intentional Teaching Experiences. Teaching Guides: The study topics are intentionally chosen to reflect and celebrate the diversity in our local community. Topics like clothes and buildings allow all children to see themselves and their community. Teachers are encouraged to focus on what the child can see and experience with their families, such as trips to the local laundromat or hardware store. These study topics also allow families to be the “star” in their children’s class. Children’s Book Collection: The goal for the books that are included in the Children’s Book Collection is for every child to see themselves and their family. Regardless of the child’s background, family composition, abilities, race, gender, or ethnicity, the goal is to have the children connect with the characters they see in literature.
Resource Prioritization	1	The proposed instructional materials will be used by every student regardless of need. In order to meet Williams Sufficiency requirements, all students regardless of need are entitled to instructional materials

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Component	Score	Score Rationale
		appropriate for their course. These instructional materials comply with CA Education Code requirements.
Results	3	Providing all students with access to quality Universal Transitional Kindergarten curriculum ensures that they have access to the same high-level educational resources, regardless of their school's location or funding. The recommended instructional materials have the content and the resources to close achievement gaps when implemented in concert with culturally responsive pedagogy.
TOTAL	7	

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Item Q

DIVISION OF INSTRUCTION (CONT.)

<u>CONTRACTOR</u>	<u>IDENTIFI- CATION NO.</u>	<u>CONTRACT TERM</u>	<u>SOURCE OF FUNDS</u>	<u>AMOUNT</u>
Active Internet Technologies, LLC, dba Finalsité	4400013030	09/12/24 – 09/11/29	General Funds (100%)	\$14,510,318

Approval of formally competed contract procured through a Request for Proposal (RFP) process for proprietary software license for Active Internet Technologies Inc., dba Finalsité. Finalsité maintains the District's fully hosted mass notification system used to communicate general, attendance, transportation, crisis and academic messages on a regular basis. In addition, it allows for the District to send an emergency message to all families and employees in the District within a single hour (over 1.6 million contacts via phone, email and text).

Finalsité's Blackboard mass notification system includes all schools, regions, region networks, and central offices. Automated messaging around absences (Pupil Services), bus delays (Transportation), IEP's (Special Education) and crisis events (School Police) are just a few examples of messages that are sent daily or frequently during the year. Schools typically send messages multiple times each week and teachers using the Blackboard Teacher Communication systems may send messages daily.

Ten proposals were received, and all were deemed qualified. Six subject matter experts from different Divisions, including the Office of Communications and Information Technology services, made up the evaluation committee. Factors utilized to score the proposals included professional qualifications and experience, work plan, technical solution, value added function, price and Small Business Enterprise (SBE) participation. The resulting contract was awarded based on the highest scored contractor.

Finalsité's Blackboard has provided mass notification services to the District for 15 years with an exemplary track record to handle the frequency and volume of messaging required by a large school district. During the 2021-2022 school year, the District sent over 1 billion messages through the mass notification system helping to address learning loss during the pandemic and other challenges.

The mass notification systems align with each of the five pillars of the Strategic Plan. Messaging around academic excellence, joy and wellness, engagement and collaboration, operational effectiveness, and investing in staff historically occurs at the school, region network, region and District levels throughout the school year. The strongest alignment is with pillar 3, engagement and collaboration, as the mass notification system is used to enhance strong relationships with students, families and employees.

Requester:

Dr. Frances Baez, Chief Academic Officer
Division of Instruction

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Equity Impact:

Component	Score	Score Rationale
Recognition	4	The capacity for schools, region networks, regions, and offices to communicate an enterprise mass notification system enables the District to precisely target student families, and communities that have historically been underserved or affected by disparities, such as homelessness and African American students.
Resource Prioritization	4	While the system is accessible to all schools, it permits a heightened level of utilization where there is a greater need. Both schools and individual teachers have the capability to dispatch targeted messages to students in need of supplemental resources.
Results	3	Utilizing the mass notification system for communication has proven to increase awareness, participation, and enrollment in academic programs like tutoring, summer school, and enrichment activities. This effectively offers additional resources and opportunities to students and families, aiding in efforts to narrow the achievement gap.
TOTAL	11	

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<u>INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY SERVICES</u>				\$1,360,000
<u>CONTRACTOR</u>	<u>IDENTIFI- CATION NO.</u>	<u>CONTRACT TERM</u>	<u>SOURCE OF FUNDS</u>	<u>AMOUNT</u>
Jada Systems, Inc.	4400013280 (RFP 2000003561)	06/24/24 – 06/23/29 includes two (2) one- year renewal options	General Funds (100%)	\$1,360,000

Approval of formally competed contract, procured through a Request for Proposals (RFP) process, to provide and implement a helpdesk solution to augment the District helpdesk support line during periods of increased call volume and unforeseen events and/or circumstances. They will act as a helpdesk overflow to create tickets, answer basic questions and escalate calls for issue resolution. These services will enhance helpdesk support responsiveness and service quality, ensuring that District community members receive timely and effective support.

Three proposals were received, and all were deemed qualified. The source selection committee was comprised of three subject matter experts from Information Technology Services (ITS). The proposals were scored based on the following evaluation criteria: experience and qualifications of firm; technical solution/project approach; price; Small Business Enterprise (SBE) participation; and Work-Based Learning Partnership (WBLP) plan. The selected contractor was the highest-scored proposer.

Jada Systems, Inc. has conducted business with the District since 2012 and has provided Help Desk services to the City of Los Angeles, Los Angeles County, City of Pasadena, San Bernardino County, and other public entities.

These services align with: Pillar 3 – Engagement and Collaboration by helping ITS provide clear, consistent, and accessible information to the community.

Requester:

Soheil Katal, Chief Information Officer
Information Technology Services

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Equity Impact:

Component	Score	Score Rationale
Recognition	1	This contract does not recognize historical inequities. The solution is to ensure all students, families, staff, and community have access to helpdesk support.
Resource Prioritization	4	Effectively prioritizes resources based on student need. The contract provides an overflow helpdesk support solution to enhance support services for students, families, staff, and community.
Results	2	May result in closed opportunity gaps and/or closing achievement gaps. The solution aims to improve responsiveness, empower users, training, and ongoing support. This contract represents a commitment to leveraging technology for enhanced support and operational excellence within LAUSD.
TOTAL	7	

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<u>TRANSPORTATION SERVICES DIVISION</u>				\$275,575
<u>CONTRACTOR</u>	<u>IDENTIFI- CATION NO.</u>	<u>CONTRACT TERM</u>	<u>SOURCE OF FUNDS</u>	<u>AMOUNT</u>
The Center for Effective School Operations, LLC	4400013355 (RFP 2000003611)	08/19/24 – 08/18/26 includes one-year renewal option	General Funds (100%)	\$275,575

Approval of formally competed contract, procured through Request for Proposals (RFP) process, to provide management and project support services, a school bell time assessment report, and tiering options development. These services will help the Transportation Services Division (TSD) manage the implementation and transition of new transportation systems and a zero-emissions vehicle fleet and provide an assessment of the District' school bell schedules to allow TSD to increase its efficiency and effectiveness.

Five proposals were received and three were deemed qualified. The source selection committee was comprised of five subject matter experts from the Office of the Chief Strategy Officer, Food Services Division, Division of Instruction, Division of District Operations, and Transportation Services Division. The proposals were scored based on the following evaluation criteria: qualifications and experience of firm & key personnel; project approach; price; Small Business Enterprise (SBE) participation; and Work-Based Learning Partnership (WBLP) plan. The selected contractor was the highest-scored proposer.

This is the contractor's first contract with the District; however, they have provided similar services to the State of Hawaii Department of Education, the Ontario Ministry of Education, Montgomery County Public Schools in Maryland, Hillsborough County Schools in Florida, Seattle Public Schools, and Minneapolis Public Schools since 2015.

These services align with Pillar 4B – Operational Effectiveness by providing TSD leadership with the resources and data to support the modernization of TSD's operations and fleet.

Requester:

Daniel Kang, Director of Transportation
Transportation Services Division

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Equity Impact:

Component	Score	Score Rationale
Recognition	3	Supports Transportation for All program, which aims to make transportation and meals accessible to all students, in addition to Special Education and Magnet students.
Resource Prioritization	3	Bell schedule tiering will allow for maximize use of Transportation and Food Services resources for students.
Results	3	Providing reliable transportation and meals for more students will improve attendance, which will thereby close opportunity gaps.
TOTAL	9	